

Naga soldiers move into action in the Dras sub-sector, 1 July 1999. The *naik* (corporal) in the foreground is armed with the 5.56mm INSAS (Indian National Small Arms Systems) assault rifle; the rifle is fitted with a sheathed bayonet. (MUSTAFA TAUSEEF/AFP via Getty Images)

On 22 May, 18 GRENADIERS and the remainder of 1 NAGA made another attempt to take Tololing, but the frontal attack again failed in the face of fire from well-entrenched Pakistanis. The second attempt had cost 56 men killed and over 100 wounded. The Indian Army developed a new plan wherein artillery and air power were to play a bigger role. The first IAF air-to-ground strikes were launched on 26 May and proved devastating. Simultaneously, sustained artillery fire, including direct firing, was carried out to soften up the Pakistani defences while the guns were being reinforced.